between these two powers, in the long run eventually a return to a limited understanding in inevitable.

The Indian spies were also worried about Chinese covert interference in Sri Lanka with the help of the US as the two countries were coming closer. China's value as an ally to the US in its anti-Soviet crusade had earned it the qualification of a friendly country entitled to the US export of lethal weapons and the privilege of the exchange of strategic intelligence on a global scale. The intimacy of the China-US relationship was reflected in the permission accorded by the Chinese in 1981 to the US to set up a joint surveillance facility, manned by Chinese technicians, at Xinziang near the China-Soviet frontier. The China-US differences over the Taiwan issue, to which China was very sensitive, was somewhat smoothened with the announcement in August 1982 that American arms sales to Taiwan would be reduced collectively and quantitatively and finally stopped within a fixed but unspecified period. This growing partnership was a cause of concern to South Asian countries. India had taken cognisance of this cooperation since it had the potential of adversely affecting its hold over neighbouring countries. The Chinese obsession with Soviet hegemonies had prompted the country to reiterate its desire to improve relations with South Asian countries and that was the thrust of the Chinese premier Zhao Ziyang's visit to South Asian countries. The Chinese approach towards the third world was a clear desire on Beijing's part to appear not merely a friend and ally but a full-fledged member of the third world.

Citing several reports, Pawan Arora said the situation around the globe, especially in East Germany, Afghanistan, Angola, Mozambique and Cuba, kept the major players away from Sri Lanka to an extent. The Russian view, Arora said, was to extend